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RAILTEL
A journey towards Digital Growth

RailTel, a Miniratna PSU under Ministry of Railways, started its journey as a Signalling and Telecom arm of the National Transporter. But within two decades, RailTel has established itself as one of the largest Neutral Telecom Infrastructure Services Provider in the country with 60000+ RKM Optical fibre network, built over exclusive right of way along the Railway Tracks, connecting 6070 stations. Along with this, RailTel also has 18000+ KM City Access network, 1050+ telecom towers, 2 UPTIME USA certified Data Centres, MeitY empaneled RailCloud, specialized Security Operation Centre. What makes this network one of most secure is the absence of any equipment from neighboring countries sharing land border with India.

Using this robust infrastructure RailTel provides a host of telecommunication services like Internet Bandwidth, Leased lines, MPLS VPN, Tower Co-location, dark fiber leasing, retail broadband – RailWire, HD Video Conferencing, e-tendering and many more. RailTel also provides Data Center services, Cloud services, Disaster Recovery and Security Operations Centre Services to mitigate cyber threats. RailTel has also emerged as a trusted ICT service provider and is executing various ICT projects like, implementing IP Based video Surveillance, NIC e-office, Hospital Management Information System, execution of Railway signaling projects etc.

Sailing Through the Pandemic

Though the deadly pandemic had a negative impact on almost every business, but RailTel not only managed to survive but also made rapid growth. The company recorded its highest ever consolidated income in FY 20-21 of Rs. 1411 Crore registering a growth of 21% and a CAGR growth of 16.6% over the past 3 years. Keeping up this growth in 21-22 also, RailTel's total revenues grew by 30% and PBT grew by 128% in the first half of 21-22 over the corresponding period of 20-21 on consolidated basis. With multiple multi crore orders RailTel currently has a healthy orderbook of Rs. 5000 cr. Demand for the services like NIC e-office, video conferencing, VPN, Internet Bandwidth, cloud services and other solutions to empower organizations to shift to digital platforms has gone up which is further going to help the company grow. The subscriber base for RailTel's retail broadband service RailWire has grown 254% since April'2020 and now the target is to grow 20x in this space in coming 2 years.

Exploring New Opportunities

RailTel has strong footholds in Railways, Coal, Defense, banking sectors which the company aims to further grow. But apart from that, RailTel is exploring opportunities in Education and Health sectors too.

RailTel has implemented Hospital Management Information System (HMIS) in Hospitals and Health Units of Indian Railways and is in process of providing Telemedicine solutions to hospitals in Karnataka. RailTel's Railway HMIS app has also been made compatible with Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission making it universal for healthcare access.

RailTel is already a registered PDOA, made 6070 Wi-Fi stations WANI compliant and has developed 'RailTel Wi-Fi' app to access them seamlessly

For education sector, RailTel has already connected 742 institutions of higher learning like IIM's, IIT's etc. through high-capacity leased lines. Now the company is offering AI based Cloud platform solutions for Online Remote Proctored Examinations, Web and AI based attendance system, Smart Classroom solution, Learning Management System etc as well.

Future Plan and Strategy

Pandemic has given a thrust in digitalization process and RailTel wants to ride the tide by offering more AI, IOT, ML based services. We are also working on opportunities of providing nationwide network for a global OTT service provider, safe city surveillance projects for networked HD CCTV's backed by AI.

RailTel is now focusing on village connectivity using its Point of Presence (POPs) at 5000 rural Wi-Fi stations. Apart from that the company will play an anchor role in the PM WANI project which envisages creating a nationwide Public Wi-Fi Ecosystem. RailTel is already a registered PDOA, made 6070 Wi-Fi stations WANI compliant and has developed 'RailTel Wi-Fi' app (C-DoT certified) to access them seamlessly.

RailTel is now exploring new projects at Indian Railways like Tunnel Radio Communication for which we are executing 3 projects at a cost of Rs.138 cr. using technology which is a first for Indian Railways. RailTel also intends to play a significant role in modernizing Train Control through execution of KAVACH (Train Collision Avoidance system) over LTE/4G high speed communication backbone.